



Zoo Explorers

Meet the Gorilla!

Critically Endangered

Facts • Colour • Activities

Gorilla Fact File ■

Scientific name:	Gorilla beringei / Gorilla gorilla
Status:	Critically Endangered
Where they live:	DR Congo, Uganda, Rwanda, Cameroon, Gabon
Habitat:	Tropical rainforests and mountain forests of Central Africa
Diet:	Herbivore — leaves, stems, fruit, bark, and roots
Weight:	135–220 kg (male), 70–90 kg (female)
Lifespan:	35–40 years in the wild
Population:	Fewer than 1,100 mountain gorillas remain

Amazing Facts ■

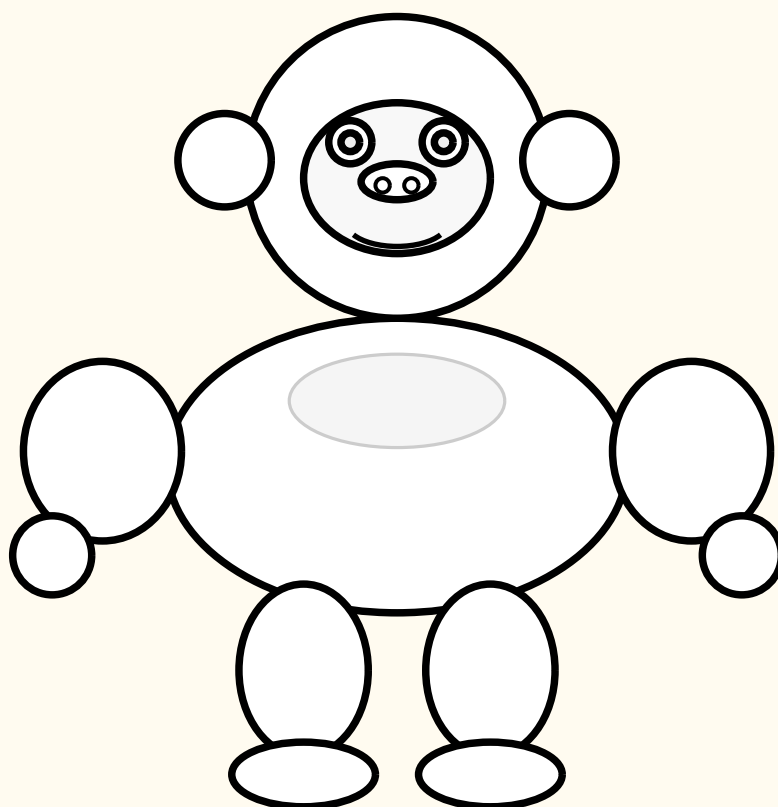
- Gorillas share 98.3% of their DNA with humans — our closest relatives after chimpanzees!
- A silverback's back hair turns silver-grey between ages 11 and 13.
- Gorillas build a brand new sleeping nest from branches every single night.
- Mountain gorillas wander a home range of up to 39 km² (15 square miles).
- Baby gorillas ride on their mother's back — just like a piggyback!
- Mountain gorilla numbers have actually increased with conservation — a rare success story!

Threats ■■

#	Threat	Impact
1	Habitat loss and deforestation	CRITICAL
2	Poaching	HIGH
3	Disease (including human respiratory illnesses)	HIGH
4	Civil conflict in their range countries	MODERATE

Colour Me! — Gorilla

Gorillas have black fur. Adult male silverbacks have a grey or silver patch on their back, which appears as they mature.



Activities ➡

Word Search — find all 8 words!

Q	R	H	O	P	G	P	I	O	O	E	J
E	D	A	J	H	R	O	W	X	L	M	T
S	N	S	I	B	A	I	R	Z	R	A	Y
V	G	D	I	N	R	F	M	I	X	E	F
Q	H	P	A	L	F	F	R	A	L	U	P
N	A	V	E	N	V	O	C	I	T	L	O
T	B	Q	R	C	G	E	R	C	C	E	A
Y	I	P	E	T	D	E	R	E	S	A	Z
B	T	R	F	U	L	T	R	B	S	U	K
E	A	Q	X	U	S	C	T	E	A	T	N
H	T	U	Y	D	U	O	T	B	D	C	N
V	Y	F	P	M	A	X	Q	V	D	V	K

GORILLA	SILVERBACK	RAINFOREST	ENDANGERED
AFRICA	PRIMATE	HABITAT	CONSERVATION

Match It Up!

Gorilla		where gorillas live
Silverback		rides on mum's back
Baby gorilla		leader of the gorilla troop
Rainforest		a danger to gorillas
Poaching		eats leaves and fruit

Fill in the Blanks!

- Gorillas live in _____ in Central Africa.
- A male gorilla leader is called a _____.
- Gorillas share ____% of their DNA with humans.
- Mountain gorillas are _____ Endangered.

Answers: rainforests | Silverback | 98.3 | Critically

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